

the use of modern materials (notably concrete, steel, and sheet glass), structural innovation, and the elimination of ornament. The Bauhaus school was Modernist, although the movement's most famous exponent was the Swiss-born French architect Le Corbusier.

MODULOR A scale of proportions devised by Le Corbusier to create a harmonic standard for design elements. The system is based on the height of an average man with one arm raised. *See also* Modernism.

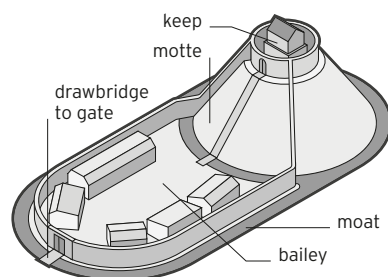
MOLDING A strip of plaster, stone, wood, or other material that decorates the top or bottom of a wall or is added around a door or window. Moldings are usually decorated with some form of pattern.

MONOLITH A single great stone that stands as a monument or as part of a monument. There is some overlap with the term megalith, although megalith tends to be used in reference to prehistoric structures. *See also* megalith.

MOSAIC An image made from an assemblage of small, flat pieces of colored stone, glass, or other materials. The small pieces are known as tesserae.

MOSQUE *See* panel, right.

MOTTE ▼ A raised mound of earth flattened on top for the placement of a defensive keep. Mottes were often encircled by a courtyard (bailey), an arrangement that is known as a motte-and-bailey castle. *See also* bailey, keep.



MUGHAL Relating to the Mughal empire, which ruled in 1526–1540 and 1555–1857. At its height, the Mughals ruled most of the Indian subcontinent and built monuments such as the Taj Mahal at Agra and the Red Fort at Delhi.

MULLION The vertical or horizontal element—of stone, wood, or other material—that divides the casements or panes of a window.

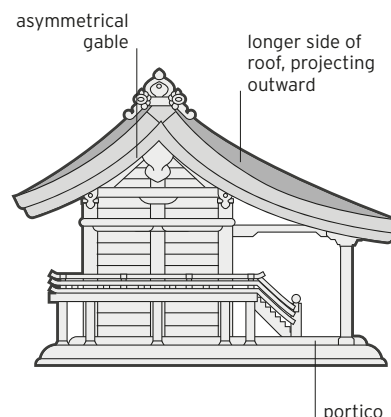
MULTIFOIL ARCH A highly ornamental arch with semicircular indentations in the underside of its curved area. It is particular to the Moorish architecture of Arab Andalusia. It is sometimes called a scalloped arch.

MUQARNA A type of vaulting found in Islamic architecture comprising clusters of little niches that decorate the uppermost parts of alcoves and the corners where walls transition into domes. *Muqarnas* are often said to resemble honeycombs or stalactites.

MURAL A painting, mosaic, or other work of art, generally on a large scale, made directly onto a wall.

N

NAGARE-ZUKURI ▼ A Japanese Shinto temple style characterized by an asymmetrical gabled roof projecting outward on one of the nongabled sides to form a portico.



NAOS The inner chamber of a temple in ancient Greek architecture. It usually contained a statue of the deity to whom the temple was dedicated.

NARTHEX The entrance or lobby area of a church, distinct from the church proper and located at the opposite end of the nave to the altar. *See also* altar, church, nave.

NAVE The central longitudinal part of the church, where typically the congregation sits. Any aisles in a church are not part of the nave. *See also* church.

NEO-CLASSICAL Relating to the revival of simple forms associated with Classical architecture, such as columns, and a preference for blank walls, during the 18th and early 19th centuries. It represented a reaction to the excesses of the Baroque and Rococo styles. *See also* Baroque, Classical, Rococo.

NEO-GOTHIC *See* Gothic Revival.

NICHE A decorative recess set into a wall, typically semicircular and topped by a semidome. A niche is usually used for displaying a statue, vase, or similar object.

O

OBELISK A tall, four-sided monument that ends in a pyramid-shaped cap. The form is most often associated with ancient Egypt.

MOSQUE

The mosque is an Islamic place of worship. As with a church, a mosque can be a simple meeting room. All mosques, however, have some form of *mihrab*, which is the niche that indicates the direction of the Kaaba at Mecca and the direction of prayer. Traditionally, a mosque will also feature a *minbar* for the preaching of sermons, an ablutions fountain for ritual washing, and a minaret for the call to prayer. Most traditional mosques in warmer regions also have a large arcaded courtyard to accommodate the expanded congregations that gather for Friday prayers, or *Jumma*.

